

# Clarity Breeds Clarity

## A LinkedIn Commentary on the Communication Breakdown in Recruitment

Keith Coetzee · Finance & Operations · Process Design · Stakeholder Communication

### WHAT THIS IS

This is not a rant.

It is a structured breakdown of a systemic communication failure sitting quietly between recruiters and candidates — and a practical proposal for fixing it.

It is also, deliberately, built in Excel.

Because the irony of a document about dashboard obsession being delivered as a dashboard felt too good to waste.

### THE PROBLEM IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Recruiters are drowning in applications and adopted ATS tools to manage volume. Candidates are drowning in rejections and adopted AI-generated CVs to survive the filter. Neither group designed this outcome. Neither group is entirely wrong. The tool sitting in the middle — the one nobody fully understands and even fewer can explain — is the problem. And right now it is being mistaken for the solution.

### THE DUMMY CAKE

There is a concept in this piece called the dummy cake.

You have seen them. Bakery window. Beautiful icing, perfect layers, wouldn't feed a sparrow. There is a polystyrene form underneath. It was never real cake.

A keyword-dense, AI-generated CV with zero demonstrated examples of skill use is a dummy cake. It passes ATS screening beautifully. It tells you almost nothing about the person attached to it.

The system rewards the icing. Not the recipe. And the bakery is currently full of them — because candidates responded rationally to the incentive the system created.

### WHAT THE FILE CONTAINS

#### Sheet 1 — LinkedIn Post

The commentary as written. Structured for direct copy into LinkedIn. Lemon on charcoal. The dummy cake section sits in sour yellow — visually, the same way it lands rhetorically.

#### Sheet 2 — The Breakdown

The analytical layer. Four sections:

- **A | The Disparity Table** — Three columns. Same situation, three simultaneous perspectives. What the recruiter experiences. What the candidate experiences. What is actually happening under the hood. They are not having the same conversation. That is the point.
- **B | The Funnel — Broken vs Proposed** — Side by side. Six stages. What the current process does at each one, and what the proposed two-layer process does instead. Current: ATS scores → recruiter interviews → hire. Failure point: ATS was never designed to judge competence. It reduces volume — including filtering out your best candidates.
- **C | The Dummy Cake Problem** — Dummy cake CV versus real CV, side by side, and what ATS does with each one. ATS was never designed to taste the difference. It cannot. That is not a criticism. It is a specification.
- **D | The One-Line Fix** — The smallest possible ask.

**"This role uses ATS / AI screening in the first round."**

One line in a job posting. Candidates calibrate. The system functions as intended. The ethical question disappears. The person who actually fits the role stops being filtered out by an algorithm that cannot read context.

## THE ARGUMENT BEING MADE

This is not anti-recruiter. Recruiters are people too. Most did not choose ATS. It was handed to them as a solution to drowning in volume. They were not told what happens under the hood. They were not shown the dummy cake problem from the other side of the process.

They parrot the complaints they hear in the industry because nobody gave them a better frame.

The disparity between recruiters and candidates is not a personality conflict. It is a communication gap with a middleware problem in the middle. And communication gaps respond well to clarity.

## WHY THIS IS BUILT IN EXCEL

Because the people most focused on dashboards as a proxy for competence needed to see this delivered in their preferred format.

A well-structured Excel file is not a dashboard. A dashboard is not insight. Insight is what happens when someone traces a problem to its root, builds a model of it, and communicates it clearly to the people who need to act on it.

That is what this is.

## SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

This piece was built to do three things simultaneously:

- Speak as a candidate — authentic, frustrated, constructive
- Think as an analyst — problem traced to root cause, funnel modelled, solution proposed
- Communicate as a stakeholder partner — complex issue made legible, no jargon, actionable close

That combination is the skill advertisement. The dummy cake is the proof of concept.

## FILE DETAILS

| ITEM           | DETAIL                                                                   |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Filename       | Clarity_Breeds_Clarity_LinkedIn.xlsx                                     |
| Sheets         | 2 — LinkedIn Post / The Breakdown                                        |
| Built in       | Microsoft Excel / openpyxl                                               |
| Colour palette | Charcoal, lemon, sour yellow, red/blue/green disparity columns           |
| Companion CVs  | CV_Recruiter_Keith_Coetzee.pdf · CV_Keyword_Dump.pdf                     |
| Data sources   | None — this is a structural and communication analysis, not a data model |

## AUTHOR

### Keith Coetzee

Finance & Operations · 25+ Years across Financial Reporting, HR/LRA/BCEA, Operational Process Design, Vendor Management, and Compliance.

Eastern Cape, South Africa · Africa/Europe time zones.

*Open to work. Prefers a fair read from a human.*

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*Clarity breeds clarity.*

*The gap closes when both sides can see the same funnel.*